

Alexander Pendragon - Combat Reference

Latest restorable Gatefall checkpoint: **900_CHECKPOINT_0029**. Recommendations are derived from the checkpoint character sheet and Gatefall World Rule Profile Sections 3.9, 4.3-4.4, 6.2, 7.2-7.4, 11.3, 11.5, and 12.9.

Level / Rank	Vitals	Effective Stats	Loadout identity	Defensive baseline
Level 8 System Rank E XP 570 / 800	Health 116 / 116 Mana 60 / 60 No injury	STR 41 AGI 55 VIT 29 PER 31 INT 30	Dual Quickknives High-Agility close combat Zero-Mana primary offense	Armor: approx 22.7% With Stone Skin: approx 45.9% With Stone Skin + Bulwark: approx 72.9%

Best overall recommendation

Fight primarily with the Ghost Quickknife. Use Keen Sense as a cheap scene opener, Flash Step for positioning, and hold Stone Skin or Bulwark for threats that justify Mana. Alexander's equipment-driven knife damage currently exceeds Rupture's raw magnitude.

Skills and ability recommendations

Skill	Cost / state	Authored use	Recommended use
Stone Skin [D]	4 Mana Novice Progress 0/3	30% physical reduction while sustained.	Activate before a prolonged physical fight. It raises total protection with the current armor to about 46%. Let it materially absorb danger if mastery growth matters.
Rupture [E]	10 Mana Adept Progress 1/3	Heavy skill strike at x2.30 of E baseline 10: 23 standard before reductions; 28 with the stored focus.	Use for a method-specific opening, a tactical finisher, or mastery growth. Do not treat it as default maximum damage: the Ghost Quickknife currently hits harder at zero Mana.
Flash Step [D]	7 Mana Practiced Progress 0/3	Instantly close or break line of sight; +1 step on the follow-up, extending one further exchange at Practiced.	Best mobility tool. Use to reach a priority target, escape a closing lane, or deliver a boosted follow-up.
Keen Sense [E]	2 Mana Novice	+1 step to detect ambushes, hidden enemies, or anomalies for the scene.	High-value and inexpensive. Activate before uncertain terrain, hidden threats, or boss searches. Pair with Pre-empt.
Dagger Mastery [E]	Passive Novice	Raises each Quickknife chassis from x0.75 to x0.85.	Always-on core of the current build. It improves either knife, but never combines both weapons' power into one strike.
Rank-Sight	Passive No mastery	Reads true Rank of Gates at or below Alexander's current E System Rank.	Use before committing to an uncertain Gate. It confirms E-Rank Gates only, not monsters or higher-Rank Gates.
Overpower	Passive No mastery	Grapple, pin, or bull-rush a target up to one Rank above Alexander: currently through D-Rank.	Use for capture, forced movement, or ally protection. Do not rely on its special authorization against C-Rank or higher foes.
Pre-empt	Passive No mastery	After an ambush warning is detected, take a normal action in the surprise exchange.	Keen Sense helps create the warning; Pre-empt converts it into action. It is not automatic ambush immunity.
Multitask	Passive No mastery	Raises simultaneous non-daily System quest capacity from one to two.	Progression utility only. It provides no direct combat benefit.
Bulwark [E]	10 Mana Novice	50% physical reduction for one exchange.	Reserve for the largest expected physical hit. With armor and Stone Skin, total reduction is about 73% for that exchange.

Equipment recommendations

Only slotted equipment applies its mechanical line. The current nine-slot loadout produces 41 Strength, 55 Agility, 29 Vitality, 31 Perception, and 30 Intelligence.

Slot	Equipment	Mechanical line	Recommendation
Main hand	Ghost Quickknife [B] Good	Agility +13 power 11 x0.85 with Dagger Mastery +1 step on first unseen attack in a combat	Keep equipped. Primary weapon, strongest zero-Mana attack, and the center of the ambush build.
Off hand	C-Rank Quickknife Good	Agility +7 power 7 x0.85 with Dagger Mastery	Keep equipped. Preserves exceptional Agility and a second mana-bearing weapon. Do not add its power to the main-hand strike.
Head	Horizon Gale Coif [D]	Agility +2 5% physical reduction	Keep. It reinforces the placement/evasion identity with solid protection.
Torso	Adaptive Bastion Torso [E]	Vitality +3 6% physical reduction	Keep. Replacing it with an Agility torso would sharply reduce maximum Health for little benefit.
Hands	Horizon Gale Gauntlets [C]	Agility +3 8% physical reduction	Keep. Best protection among the worn pieces and directly supports weapon placement.
Legs	Shin Guards [E]	Vitality +1 3% physical reduction	Keep. The stored Armored Greave has the same authored line and unresolved ownership.
Feet	Titan Boots [E]	Strength +1 3% physical reduction	Keep. Small but direct improvement to knife damage and force actions.
Accessory 1	Ascendant Hunter's Band [E]	Strength +4	Keep. Substantially improves every physical strike and Overpower attempt.
Accessory 2	Ascendant Hunter's Band [D]	Strength +5	Keep. Duplicate accessories stack; the two Bands supply Strength +9 together.

Current offensive comparison

Attack option	Standard result before target reduction	Recommendation
Ghost Quickknife	$(41 \text{ Strength} + 11 \text{ power}) \times 0.85 = \mathbf{44}$	Default attack. Highest current no-Mana damage plus the first-unseen opening effect.
C-Rank Quickknife	$(41 + 7) \times 0.85 = \mathbf{41}$	Secondary physical option. Dual wielding does not pool power into one strike.
Rupture	$10 \text{ baseline} \times 2.30 = \mathbf{23}$	Use for tactical method or mastery, not raw damage efficiency.
Rupture + Channeling Focus	$(10 + 2 \text{ focus}) \times 2.30 = \mathbf{28}$	Still weaker than the Ghost knife and costs the Ghost's Agility, weapon power, and unseen effect.

Stored equipment and tools

Stored item	State	Recommendation
Channeling Focus [E]	Intelligence +2 focus power 2 stored	Situational only. It raises Rupture from 23 to about 28, but replacing the Ghost knife loses Agility +13, power 11, and the unseen opener.
Armored Greave [E]	Vitality +1 3% reduction ownership unresolved	No mechanical upgrade over the equipped Shin Guards. Leave stored until ownership or condition changes.
Standard and Longhaul resonance chisels	Undamaged harvest tools	Use for extraction, not combat. No authored combat line exists.
Original resonance chisel	Broken	Unusable. Broken equipment applies no mechanical line.

Tactical reserves

These are not part of the equipped loadout, but they materially change survival and planning.

Reserve	Available	Effect	Recommendation
Status Recovery	5 pending	Immediately restores Health and Mana to maxima and clears ordinary fatigue. Does not clear injury severity.	Best emergency reset. Spend after meaningful Health and Mana loss, not merely to erase a small scratch.
Ability Points	+3 pending	Three permanent base-Stat points, allocatable at any time.	Allocate for a deliberate build goal. No current Stat is close enough to 50 for three points to trigger another milestone ability.
Lesser healing potion	4	Restores 25% of maximum Health: currently 29 Health.	Use for moderate attrition when a full Status Recovery would be wasteful.
Antidote	2	Clears poison or venom of the drinker's Rank or below: currently E-Rank.	Carry as the answer to E-Rank toxins. It does not cover higher-Rank poison.
Mender's Seal	1	Clears one Minor injury or reduces one Moderate injury to Minor; restores no Health.	Use alongside healing when severity persists. It is treatment, not a Health refill.
Stabilization Seal	1	Suspends a Critical injury's untreated death risk for 24 hours; restores no Health and clears no severity.	Last-resort bridge to professional treatment.
Runic Key [E]	1	Opens an E-Rank instance with a guaranteed rune in addition to the boss's normal drop.	Progression opportunity, not an in-combat consumable. Enter only with a recovery and exit plan.

Recovery rule that matters

Full Health does not remove injury severity. Status Recovery and healing potions restore the Health axis; the Mender's Seal acts on Minor or Moderate severity, while the Stabilization Seal only delays Critical risk.

Loadout decision guide

If the encounter emphasizes...	Recommended preparation	Avoid
Unknown terrain or hidden threats	Keep dual knives. Activate Keen Sense early. Preserve Pre-empt for a real warning.	Assuming high Agility alone prevents an ambush.
Prolonged physical pressure	Stone Skin before the exchange sequence; reserve Bulwark for the largest hit.	Adding reductions arithmetically or assuming protection against poison and environmental effects.
Capture or forced movement	Use the Strength-band accessories and Overpower against D-Rank or lower targets.	Extending Overpower's authorization to C-Rank targets.
Skill training	Choose distinct dangerous scenes where the skill materially contributes; one continuous scene gives at most one mastery point.	Spamming a skill in one scene and expecting several mastery contributions.
Mana scarcity	Use Keen Sense once, then rely on Quickknives. Save Flash Step and Bulwark for decisive exchanges.	Repeated Rupture casts when an ordinary knife strike is stronger and free.

Recommended fighting strategies

Each strategy combines the checkpoint loadout, learned skills, and tactical reserves. Mana totals list active skill costs only; physical knife attacks cost no Mana.

Strategy	Sequence	Mana	Why it works	Primary caution
1. Efficient knife fighter	Keen Sense before danger -> Ghost Quickknife as primary offense -> Flash Step only when position breaks	2 baseline 9 with Flash Step	The B-Rank knife deals about 44 standard damage at zero Mana. Keen Sense lasts for the scene.	Less explosive if the encounter denies close-range placement.
2. Unseen execution opener	Keen Sense -> establish a genuinely unseen approach -> Ghost first strike -> Flash Step to maintain pressure	9	Combines detection, the Ghost's first-unseen +1, Agility 55, Dagger Mastery, and extended Practiced Flash Step.	The equipment does not grant invisibility. Unseen status must exist in the fiction.
3. Defensive boss duel	Stone Skin before engagement -> knife offense -> Bulwark for the heaviest expected exchange	14	Approx 46% sustained physical reduction and approx 73% on the Bulwark exchange.	Physical damage only; special hazards may bypass the entire plan.
4. Mobile skill combo	Flash Step -> Rupture as boosted follow-up -> return to knife pressure	17	Uses Flash Step's +1 placement and develops two mastery-tracked skills in a dangerous scene.	Rupture's raw standard magnitude is lower than the Ghost knife's current physical strike.
5. Capture and control	Keen Sense -> detect movement -> Pre-empt if ambushed -> Overpower grapple, pin, or bull-rush	2	Strength 41 supports direct force, and Overpower explicitly authorizes control through D-Rank.	The Overpower envelope ends at D-Rank while Alexander remains System Rank E.
6. Mana-conservation clear	Keen Sense once -> zero-Mana knife attacks -> reserve Flash Step and Bulwark for emergencies	2 baseline	Preserves the 60-Mana pool while using Alexander's strongest equipment-driven offense.	Requires disciplined positioning and ordinary attack resolution.
7. Emergency reset	Bulwark if the decisive hit can still be mitigated -> Status Recovery after substantial loss -> severity item if injury remains	10 plus reserve	Correctly separates prevention, pool restoration, and injury treatment.	Status Recovery can leave Alexander at full Health while still seriously injured.
8. Focus / Rupture specialist	Swap Ghost Quickknife for Channeling Focus -> use Rupture -> swap back when the skill phase ends	10 per Rupture	Raises standard Rupture from 23 to about 28 and increases effective Intelligence while equipped.	Loses Agility +13, the stronger knife, and the Ghost unseen-opening effect. Not recommended as the default build.

Priority order

1. Detect with Keen Sense. **2.** Win placement with Agility and Flash Step. **3.** Deal sustained damage with the Ghost Quickknife. **4.** Add Stone Skin or Bulwark only when the threat justifies them. **5.** Treat Status Recovery as a finite tactical reset, not routine healing.

Checkpoint data-quality note

Checkpoint 0029 records Keen Sense at zero successful uses even though its Cicero Gate narrative records an activation. Dagger Mastery's zero-use counter also conflicts with subsequent dagger attacks. The stored Channeling Focus note says no known skill uses focus power, although Rupture qualifies under Section 6.2. These are stale counters or notes; the authored effects and costs above remain clear.

Primary sources: campaigns/gatefall_pendragon_001/saves/900_CHECKPOINT_0029/900_SAVE_MANIFEST.md, 100_CHARACTER_SHEET.md, 120_INVENTORY_AND_OWNERSHIP.md; worlds/gatefall/206_WORLD_RULE_PROFILE.md.